

World people

The human story began in Africa six million years ago, when apes began to walk upright on two legs. Over time, humanlike apes, called hominins, grew bigger and more intelligent. Our species, *Homo sapiens*, appeared in Africa 200,000 years ago. Around 120,000 years ago, some of them left Africa to spread all over the world.

Fire maker

Homo erectus (upright man) was the first hominin to leave Africa, 1.8 million years ago. They were the same height as we are, but their faces were more apelike. They made stone axes and learned to control fire.



Homo erectus



Cave painting

Modern humans in Europe, Asia, and Australia began to make art 35,000 years ago. They painted pictures of the animals they hunted on the walls of caves.